

GOPI K KANCHARLA

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TECHNOLOGY EXECUTIVE | ENGINEERING AND PLATFORM LEADERSHIP

Platform Engineering | Cloud Infrastructure | Low-Latency Distributed Systems | Data Platforms | Cybersecurity and Technology Risk

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technology executive with 20+ years in software engineering, platform engineering, cloud infrastructure, and large-scale distributed systems, including 7+ years leading global engineering organizations as a manager of managers and executive. Player-coach leader who pairs Principal Engineer architectural depth with the operational rigor required to run mission-critical financial systems where uptime, latency, and resilience are paramount.

Proven in highly regulated, mission-critical environments across financial services, commercial and consumer lending, and capital markets, including next-generation trading platforms built for real-time market data and low-latency execution. Designs, builds, and operates high-throughput, low-latency distributed systems with stringent availability, scalability, security, and operational resilience requirements, backed by 28 issued patents as primary inventor in distributed systems, cloud storage, resiliency, and automation.

Deep expertise in modern cloud and platform engineering across multi-cloud environments (AWS, Azure, GCP), Infrastructure-as-Code, Kubernetes and container deployment, CI/CD automation, observability platforms, and cloud-native architecture. Strong command of modern data ecosystems spanning data lakes, lakehouses, real-time streaming, data pipelines, analytics platforms, and MLOps infrastructure.

Institutionalizes security-by-design across the software development lifecycle, with accountability for security architecture, threat modeling, vulnerability management, identity and access controls, regulatory compliance, technology governance, and operational risk frameworks. Recognized for translating complex technical, operational, and security risk into clear business outcomes and strategic recommendations for senior stakeholders.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Technology Strategy and Platform Leadership | Core Technology Platforms | Platform Engineering | Engineering Standards and Architectural Governance | Developer Productivity and Developer Tooling | Technology Roadmap and Portfolio Planning

Cloud and Infrastructure: Multi-Cloud (AWS, Azure, GCP) | Cloud-Native Architecture | Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform) | Kubernetes and Containers | CI/CD Automation | DevSecOps | Site Reliability Engineering | Observability and Telemetry | SLOs and Error Budgets | High Availability | Disaster Recovery | Operational Resilience

Distributed Systems: High-Throughput and Low-Latency Systems | Real-Time Data and Event-Driven Architecture | Microservices and API Platforms | Fault Tolerance | Horizontal Scalability | Capacity and Performance Engineering | Incident Management and Production Accountability

Data Platforms: Data Lakes and Lakehouses | Real-Time Streaming (Kafka) | Data Pipelines | Analytics Platforms | Data Governance and Lineage | MLOps and LLMops Infrastructure | Model Governance | AI and GenAI Platform Enablement

Cybersecurity and Risk: Security-by-Design | Secure SDLC | Security Architecture | Threat Modeling | Vulnerability Management | Identity and Access Management | Policy-as-Code | Regulatory Compliance | Technology Governance | Operational Risk Frameworks | Audit Readiness

Leadership: Global Engineering Organizations | Manager of Managers | Talent Acquisition and Development | Organizational Transformation | Executive Communication and Presence | Senior Stakeholder Influence | Vendor and Budget Management | Agile and SAFe

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

TOYOTA FINANCIAL SERVICES - Plano, Texas

Head of Technology, Banking and Commercial Lending / Consumer Lending

03/2025 - Present

- Own technology strategy, architecture, engineering execution, and production accountability for core lending platforms in a regulated financial services environment, directing a \$185M annual technology portfolio across engineering, platform, and infrastructure investment.

- Directed delivery of a new, scalable commercial loan origination platform supporting \$30B in originations, serving critical dealer and commercial-finance journeys with stringent availability and data-integrity requirements.
- Architected cloud-native, multi-cloud platform foundations using Infrastructure-as-Code, Kubernetes-based container deployment, automated CI/CD, and observability tooling, reducing annual cloud and infrastructure run cost by \$12M.
- Established SLO-driven reliability engineering, platform guardrails, observability, and operational playbooks that sustained 99.99% availability across mission-critical applications processing 4M+ transactions per day.
- Tripled release velocity through end-to-end DevSecOps, API automation, reusable platform capabilities, and automated controls, materially improving developer productivity across globally distributed teams.
- Designed a configuration-driven user-interface platform that cut selected change cycles from one month to approximately five minutes, avoiding \$6M in annual delivery cost.
- Built AI/ML-enabled credit-risk and customer-experience capabilities with governed model access, monitoring, auditability, and human oversight, driving a 15% lift in approval rates and a 20% reduction in defaults.
- Institutionalized security-by-design across the SDLC, embedding threat modeling, vulnerability management, identity and access controls, and policy-as-code enforcement, reducing risk incidents by 25% and strengthening audit and regulatory posture.
- Serve as the senior technical escalation point and trusted advisor to executive leadership, translating architecture, resilience, and security risk into clear business outcomes and investment decisions.
- Recruit, mentor, and develop engineering managers and senior technical leaders, fostering a culture of technical excellence, accountability, and continuous learning.

CAPITAL ONE - Plano, Texas

02/2016 - 03/2025

Director, Software Engineering - Marketing Technology and Analytics, Decisioning, Auto Finance | 12/2021 - 03/2025

Senior Manager, Software Engineering | 03/2019 - 11/2021

Manager, Software Engineering | 03/2017 - 02/2019

Master Software Engineer | 02/2016 - 02/2017

- Led global engineering organizations of up to 120 engineers across regions and time zones, owning a \$95M annual portfolio with accountability for strategy, architecture, delivery, governance, security, and operational maturity.
- Defined and executed a marketing-technology platform strategy that reduced Adobe vendor lock-in, strengthened data governance and control of customer data, and delivered \$240M+ in revenue impact.
- Built and operated high-throughput data platforms and real-time streaming pipelines feeding analytics, decisioning, and personalization for millions of customer interactions, processing 850M+ events per day across data lake and lakehouse architectures.
- Delivered consumer loan origination decisioning systems and multi-lending and pricing platforms connecting business policy, data, models, APIs, and digital experiences under strict regulatory and fair-lending controls.
- Drove cloud-native modernization on AWS with Infrastructure-as-Code, containerized deployment, automated CI/CD, and observability, reducing infrastructure and licensing spend by \$18M annually.
- Built AI/ML and MLOps infrastructure supporting model training, deployment, monitoring, and governance for marketing, targeting, experimentation, and decisioning use cases.
- Embedded secure software development practices, identity and access controls, threat modeling, and compliance requirements into platform delivery in partnership with Cybersecurity, Risk, and Compliance.
- Represented engineering strategy and platform decisions to senior executives, translating technical choices into business value, operational risk, customer impact, and investment need.

DELL EMC / EMC CORPORATION - New Jersey and Texas

Senior Cloud Software Architect / Engineering Leader | 07/2013 - 01/2016

Cloud Engineer Specialist | 05/2011 - 07/2013

- Owned architecture and engineering leadership for ECS, ViPR, and UIM enterprise cloud and object-storage platforms adopted by global enterprise and financial-services customers managing petabyte-scale data.
- Designed distributed, fault-tolerant, highly available, disaster-recovery-ready systems for large-scale enterprise data and storage workloads with stringent throughput, latency, and durability requirements.
- Led \$11M multi-year engineering programs, coordinating architecture, execution, scope, schedules, resources, and product commitments across globally distributed teams.
- Created reusable architecture patterns, platform standards, APIs, orchestration capabilities, and automation for storage provisioning and distributed cloud systems, generating \$25M in operational savings for enterprise customers.
- Served as primary inventor on patented innovations in distributed systems, cloud storage, automation, resiliency, and user-experience technologies.

IPC SYSTEMS INC. - Fairfield, Connecticut

Frontend Engineering Leader | 05/2010 - 05/2011

Principal UI Engineer | 10/2009 - 05/2010

- Delivered next-generation trading platforms for capital markets, handling real-time market data, low-latency execution workflows, and demanding reliability requirements where downtime carries direct trading loss.
- Led a globally distributed engineering team of 60+ across regions and time zones, supporting round-the-clock development for market-infrastructure technology.
- Established enterprise coding, design, user-interface, and architecture standards that improved engineering consistency and delivery quality across the trading platform portfolio.

ADESA INC. - Carmel, Indiana

Lead Software Engineer - Java/J2EE | 01/2008 - 05/2009

- Led delivery of full-stack applications for online vehicle auctions, inventory management, and live auction-floor data with real-time bidding and settlement workflows.

IBM - Bengaluru, India and Bari, Italy

Technical Lead | 12/2006 - 01/2008

Senior Systems Engineer / Systems Engineer | 08/2004 - 12/2006

- Delivered ACG Express capabilities and enterprise systems using Java/J2EE, web services, reporting, CRM, database, and integration technologies.

ENTREPRENEURIAL AND 0-TO-1 PLATFORM LEADERSHIP

Founded and personally built four ventures from concept to production, owning product strategy, architecture, engineering execution, launch, and platform evolution.

- RunningTicker.com: Conceived and scaled a financial analytics platform from zero to a successful exit.
- RentMitra Inc.: AI-powered rental marketplace connecting property owners and tenants through automated workflows (<https://rentmitra.lovable.app>).
- GingerKnife Inc. / VantaShala.com: AI-backed HomeChefs marketplace built and led from the ground up (<https://VantaShala.com>).
- AlliBilli.com: All-in-one news platform designed for elderly users (<https://allibilli.com>).

PATENTS, PUBLICATIONS, AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- Primary inventor on 28 issued patents from 37 filings in distributed systems, cloud storage, resiliency, automation, and related technologies.
- Founder and author of ThinkSpecial, with 100+ published articles on engineering, cloud platforms, distributed systems, architecture, AI, and leadership (<https://medium.com/thinkspecial>).
- Speaker at Cloud Expo International, DZone Live, and enterprise executive forums on distributed systems, cloud architecture, and engineering leadership.
- Advisor to early-stage AI ventures and mentor to technology, engineering, and STEM leaders.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Information Systems - Nagarjuna University, Guntur, India | 2003

Bachelor of Computer Applications - Nagarjuna University, India | 2001

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect

SAFe Certified

Java Certification

LOCATION AND AVAILABILITY

Based in Frisco, Texas | Open to relocation | Portfolio: <https://gopikancharla.com> | Experienced leading remote and globally distributed engineering organizations